

LUCKNOW | First Off The Blocks

Mayawati is already making her moves. The Uttar Pradesh chief minister has begun putting her election organisational machinery in place months before the 2012 assembly polls. She has met her electoral coordinators, reshuffled their portfolios and revived the *bhai-chara* (brotherhood) committees. The committees are aimed at social integration of the Dalits and the OBCs with the upper castes. Her Man Friday, Rajya Sabha member and the BSP's legal adviser Satish Chand Mishra has been entrusted with consolidating the party's support among the upper castes. Now on a tour of the state as chairman of the Uttar Pradesh



MAYAWATI WITH MISHRA

State Council, Mishra is holding meetings for the speedy implementation of the party's plans. The state Congress, though, is fighting among itself, the SP is recovering from setbacks and the BJP is still struggling to find a footing in Uttar Pradesh.

by Subhash Mishra

BUZZ OF THE WEEK

It's a game of musical chairs before the next Cabinet reshuffle. Ghulam Nabi Azad and Ambika Soni are keen to go back to the Cabinet while Kapil Sibal, Anand Sharma, S.M. Krishna and G.K. Vasan are aching for a change.

CHANDIGARH | Tank You, and Sorry

Unusually frantic activity was seen in Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal's office on June 14. Blame it on the torment from the tank. In a reenactment of a

PROTESTORS ATOP THE WATER TANK



SANJAY KUMAR

famous scene from *Sholay*, some Veterinary Pharmacists' Union activists climbed a water tank in Bathinda and made a loud speech. Its gist: accept our demand, give us jobs or we will jump. The vet pharmacists only climbed down after the government gave its assurance in writing. The same day, unemployed linemen and teachers had climbed a water tank in Ropar. Most of the tank cranks have fickle demands. Jobless teachers climbed aboard wanting everyone like them to be absorbed into government jobs. The Government insists it will not recruit more than the vacancies available. To put a lid on such theatrics, maybe Badal's Government needs to tighten 'security' around all high-rise installations.

by Arvind Chhabra

MUMBAI | Face Off

The Bombay High Court has ruled that political leaders waving joyfully from illegal hoardings, banners and posters can actually face criminal prosecution for abetting nuisance, according to the Indian Penal Code. The court has stated that party members may "eulogise" these leaders in these hoardings but the cutouts and banners also



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cause public nuisance and environmental issues. Plus, the court said, the banners are eyesores that deface the city and are set up without legal permission from the civic bodies. If the posters are not removed despite warnings, the court has declared that violators of the rule face punishment of a Rs 200 fine and a jail term of up to five years. This high court order came in the course of a case related to illegal hoardings in Aurangabad.

by Mitali Patel